



Set Up Your Own Leasing Search.

A plain-English guide — no coding, and you never open or edit a single file. If you can install an app and copy-and-paste into a website, you can do this. We go one small step at a time and tell you exactly what you'll see after each one.

~15 min

start to finish

Double-click

no terminal, no code

Your PC

your searches stay
home

Your own commercial-leasing search over four metros — New York, Miami, Los Angeles, Chicago — running on your computer, at no cost beyond the API keys you choose to bring.

Three phases. You can stop after two.

Here's the entire journey before we start, so nothing is a surprise. You'll only ever **double-click** and **use your web browser** — never a command, never a file.

1

Install the engine — Windows only

WINDOWS

On **Windows**, install one free thing: **Python** — the "motor" OpenLease runs on. Two clicks and one checkbox. On a **Mac**, skip this entirely — the motor is already built in.

2

Turn OpenLease on

FREE

Double-click one file. OpenLease opens in your web browser with four metros and a small demo of listings already loaded, so there's something to search immediately.

3

Add your keys (the AI)

OPTIONAL

Plain-English search, the conversational reply, semantic ranking, a Street View thumbnail — each is a "key" you paste into the app's Settings page. Add what you need.

You never touch code or files. After Phase 2, OpenLease already searches its demo listings across all four metros — for free, no key. Phase 3 is a menu you turn on inside the app, by pasting keys. There's no wrong order and nothing to break.

On a Mac? Start at Phase 2. Macs already have the engine built in, so Phase 1 is for Windows only — skip it. That makes the whole thing about **10 minutes** for you.

Install the engine

PHASE 1

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Windows only — one download, one checkbox, ~3 min.

Mac owners: skip this page.

On a Mac? You are already done with Phase 1. macOS ships with Python — the engine OpenLease runs on — already installed. Nothing to download, nothing to click. Turn the page to Phase 2.

1

Download Python

In your web browser, go to the address below and click the big yellow **Download Python** button at the top. Don't worry about the version number — whichever one it offers is the right one.

➤ python.org/downloads

What you'll see: a file downloading, with a name like `python-3.13.exe`, in your **Downloads** folder.

2

Run it — and tick the box

Open your **Downloads** folder and double-click the file you just downloaded. An installer window opens with two buttons and a couple of checkboxes at the bottom.

This is the one thing you must not miss. At the bottom of that window, tick "**Add python.exe to PATH**" before you click anything else. It's a small checkbox and it is easy to skip — but without it, OpenLease can't find the engine and won't start.

Then click **Install Now** and let it run. If Windows asks "Do you want to allow this app to make changes?", click **Yes**.

3

Close it

When it says **Setup was successful**, click **Close**. That's the whole phase — no account, no restart, nothing to leave running.

You're done when: the installer says **Setup was successful** and closes. Python now sits quietly in the background forever; you will never open it or think about it again.

Engine installed.

That's the only software you'll ever install for OpenLease. Turn the page and let's switch the tool on.

Turn OpenLease on

PHASE 2

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Download, unzip, double-click — it opens in your browser. ~5 min.

1

Download OpenLease

In your browser, go to OpenLease's page on GitHub, click the green **Code** button, then **Download ZIP**.

➤ github.com/dweng1572179/openlease

What you'll see: a file named `openlease-main.zip` in your Downloads folder.

2

Unzip it

Open your **Downloads** folder and double-click `openlease-main.zip`. A folder appears. Drag it onto your **Desktop** so it's easy to find — the folder's name doesn't matter, only where you can find it again.

3

Double-click "Start OpenLease"

Open that folder on your Desktop. Right there — not in any sub-folder — is the file for your computer. Double-click it:

Mac `Start OpenLease.command` · **Windows** `Start OpenLease.bat`

Mac may say "unidentified developer." If it blocks the file, **right-click** it → **Open** → **Open**. You only do this once, ever.

What you'll see: a black window opens and shows progress. **The first time takes a couple of minutes** while it builds your tool — this is normal. Leave the window; after this it starts in seconds.

4

Log in

Your browser opens by itself to your new tool. If it doesn't within a minute, open your browser and type this into the address bar:

➤ `localhost:8788`

In the **Password** box type the starting password, then click the blue **Sign in** button:

Password `changeme`

Change it later: the password lives in a file called `.env` next to `Start OpenLease`, as `OPENLEASE_PASSWORD` — worth changing if this machine is reachable by anyone but you.



You're in — that's the setup.

Pick a metro and search right now — four cities, a small demo of listings, a map, no key required. Start/stop anytime with the `Start OpenLease` / `Stop OpenLease` files; turn the page to add the AI.

PHASE 3

Add your keys — the AI

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Optional. Each key unlocks more, and it's all done inside the app.



How to add any key — the same 3 clicks every time

1. In OpenLease, click **Settings** — the small link in the very **top-right corner**.
2. You'll see a labeled box for each key. **Paste** your key into the box with the matching name, then click **Save**.
3. The Settings page shows which capabilities are **live** next to what you just switched on. Done — no restart, ever.

None of these are required to search. The demo listings, a CSV you import, and the free government feeds already carry full address/size/rent with no key at all. A key only matters for two things: letting you type a sentence instead of picking filters (and getting a written reply), and letting the crawler read size/rent off an ordinary broker page that doesn't publish them as structured data.



Anthropic (Claude)

Plain-English search, the conversational reply, per-listing chat, and reading size/rent off pages that don't publish them structurally

~\$5–20/mo

pay as you go

1. Go to **console.anthropic.com** and sign up (email or Google), confirming your email.
2. Click **Billing** → add a card → **Buy credits** (a few dollars is enough to start). **Do this first — the key won't work without credit.**
3. Click **API Keys** → **Create Key**, then **copy it right away** (it's shown only once).
4. In OpenLease: Settings → paste into **Anthropic API key** → **Save**.

⌚ ~5 min



A few cents per AI action; you prepay and spend down slowly

Key starts with

sk-ant-



Voyage AI

Semantic ranking — matches "creative loft office" to a listing that never uses those words

~Free

generous free tier

1. Go to **dash.voyageai.com** and sign up (email or Google) — no card required for the free tier.
2. Open **API Keys** in the dashboard, click **Create**, and copy the key.
3. In OpenLease: Settings → paste into **Voyage API key** → **Save**.

⌚ ~3 min



The free tier covers this size of corpus roughly 400× over

Only affects ranking, never a hard filter



Google Maps

~Free

One thing only: the Street View thumbnail on a listing page

ordinary personal use

1. Go to **console.cloud.google.com**, create (or pick) a project, and enable the **Street View Static API**.
2. Under **Credentials**, click **Create Credentials → API key**, then copy it. Restricting the key to just that one API is recommended.
3. In OpenLease: Settings → paste into **Google Maps key** → **Save**.

🕒 ~5 min

💡 Requires a billing-enabled Google Cloud project, even though ordinary personal use stays inside the free tier

Nothing else in OpenLease uses this key

Which keys do you actually need? If you just want the four metros, the map, parcel data, and Walk/Transit Score — nothing. It already works. Add **Anthropic** when you want to type a sentence instead of picking filters, want the written reply and per-listing chat, or want the crawler to read size/rent off an ordinary web page. Add **Voyage** once you have enough listings that "similar to this one" is worth having — it's nearly free. Add **Google Maps** only for the Street View thumbnail.

Try the exact search this guide is written around.

This isn't a hypothetical example — it's the search this whole guide, and the app's own README, describe. With the demo listings loaded (they load automatically) and **no API key configured**, do this:

1

Pick Miami

At the top of the OpenLease home page, set the metro to **Miami**.

2

Type the search

Into the search box, type exactly this, and press search:

Search retail in Wynwood ~1,500 SF under \$8k/mo

3

Read the banner

\$8,000/mo works out to a rent cap of about **\$64/SF/yr** for a 1,500 SF space ($8000 \times 12 \div 1500$). The one listing that otherwise matches — 2618 NW 2nd Ave, Wynwood — actually asks **\$95/SF/yr**.

What you'll see: a banner across the results plainly saying the rent cap was relaxed to surface this listing, instead of either hiding zero results or quietly pretending it was a clean match. One result card, one pin on the map.

4

Open the listing

Click the result card. You'll land on a listing page with a Walk Score breakdown (per amenity category), a parcel panel (owner/zoning where the county publishes it), and a **Save** button.

That's the whole promise, in one search.

Real listing, real map pin, an honest banner about what it had to relax to find it — and not one API key was used anywhere in this walkthrough.

Three ways listings get in.

In order of how much you should trust them — and what each one costs you in risk.

1. Free government feeds

No terms-of-service surface at all. NYC's Storefront Registry publishes a **vacancy flag** on every ground-floor commercial space in the city — **43,978 vacant storefronts** citywide as of this writing — via `POST /api/import/storefronts`. That's a lead source no broker site publishes.

2. Your own CSV

A broker export, a CoStar pull, whatever you already have rights to: `POST /api/import/csv`.

3. The crawler

`POST /api/crawl`, over the allowlist in `app/data/sources.yml`. Size and asking rent from a crawled page generally need the Anthropic key to read out of the page's prose — the government feed and your own CSV already arrive structured.

What the crawler will not do.

It never logs in. Not to any site, not ever, and there is no setting to turn that on — no account, no cookie, no registration- or NDA-gated page. Getting past a bot-wall on a page that's already public is one thing; crossing an authentication wall is another, and OpenLease doesn't do the second one, ever.

It stores facts, not expression. Address, size, ask, type, broker contact, and a link back to the original — never the broker's marketing paragraph verbatim (OpenLease writes its own description from the facts) and never a re-hosted copy of their photo (it's hot-linked from the broker's own server).

It identifies itself honestly and asks first. It reads and obeys `robots.txt`, including `Crawl-delay`, under the same identity the whole way through. One request every 3–5 seconds per domain, backing off if a site is struggling, a daily cap per domain, and it re-uses what it already has rather than re-asking every time.

What a metro doesn't publish, it says it doesn't publish.

Every metro has at least one field the public data simply does not carry.

OpenLease shows that as a labeled gap, with the reason on hover — never a blank pretending to be a zero.

Los Angeles — owner name

LA County does not publish owner-of-record for free; California statute keeps it out of the open assessor feed.

Chicago — zoning (suburbs)

The zoning dataset is the [City of Chicago's own](#) layer — it's blank for anything in suburban Cook County, because the city doesn't zone land it doesn't govern.

Miami — zoning (incorporated cities)

Miami-Dade's county zoning layer only covers unincorporated land. Inside cities like Wynwood and Brickell, OpenLease falls through to the municipal layer — and it's still blank wherever neither one publishes.

A tool that guesses is worse than a tool that admits it doesn't know. Every one of these reads "not published here," with the specific reason, rather than a silent blank or an invented value.

What it really costs.

OpenLease itself is free — you only pay the AI providers for what you use, at **their** price, with no markup. Here's an honest estimate so nothing surprises you.

Anthropic (Claude) — search, replies, chat, extraction

A few cents per AI action, prepaid and spent down.

\$5–20

per month, as you use it

Voyage AI — semantic ranking

Free tier covers this corpus roughly 400× over.

\$0

essentially always free

Google Maps — Street View thumbnail

One image per listing view; ordinary personal use stays inside the free tier.

\$0

free tier, personal use

Parcels, storefront vacancy, Walk/Transit Score, OSRM

Real government and OpenStreetMap data. No meaningful limits.

\$0

always free

YOUR LIKELY BILL

Keyless (demo data / your CSV / gov **\$0/mo** feeds only)

Occasional AI use **~\$5–15/mo**

Daily use, several metros **~\$20–40/mo**

...and you're paying the AI providers directly — at cost, no seats, no expiring credits.

THE COMMERCIAL SUBSCRIPTIONS THIS REPLACES

Hundreds/mo per seat

Typically an annual contract, a per-seat fee, and a sales call before you see a price at all.

Rule of thumb: only add the keys you'll actually use, and keep an eye on the spend meter at the top of the app. It caps paid calls at a monthly limit you set in Settings.



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You own it now.

OpenLease runs on your computer, with your own keys, showing your searches to no one. No subscription, no seat fee, no expiring credits. Start it any time by double-clicking **Start OpenLease** in the openlease folder.

It's private

Everything saves on your machine. Your searches and saved listings never leave it.

It's yours

Keys are pasted in Settings and can be changed or removed anytime. No lock-in.

It's honest

Every score explains itself, every missing field says why, and every AI fallback is disclosed rather than hidden.



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OpenLease — made to be owned, not rented.